

# New Generation English Test

## Academic Entrance Diagnostic

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|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Level           | C2 - Proficiency Diagnostic                                           |
| Skills assessed | Reading, Listening, Writing, Speaking, Grammatical Range and Accuracy |
| Format          | Academic entrance diagnostic test                                     |

### Reading

#### Proficiency, judgement and the problem of excessive language

At the highest levels, language proficiency is rarely a matter of knowing more grammar in a simple quantitative sense. The learner's challenge becomes rhetorical: choosing how direct to be, deciding which implication can be left unstated, recognising when precision becomes pedantry, and when fluency begins to conceal vagueness. A speaker may produce complex sentences and still fail to sound intellectually controlled if every idea is overstated or every qualification is treated as a decorative flourish.

This is why advanced diagnostics should not merely ask whether a structure is correct. Correctness remains necessary, but it is no longer sufficient. The stronger question is whether the language is proportionate to the situation. A complaint to an institution, an academic response, a seminar intervention and a personal reflection may all require accurate grammar, yet they demand different degrees of compression, tact and explicitness. The advanced learner must therefore demonstrate not just range, but restraint.

Task design can distort this judgement. A simplistic prompt may reward speed while concealing weak interpretation; an excessively academic prompt may reward familiarity with a genre rather than genuine control. A responsible C2 diagnostic uses several lenses: dense reading, layered listening, extended writing, spontaneous speaking and grammar items that test judgement as well as form. It should ask not only whether an answer is correct, but whether it is purposeful, responsive to context and stylistically mature.

The best feedback at this level sounds less like a verdict and more like an editorial conversation. It notices when complexity becomes ornament, when caution becomes evasion, and when fluency loses precision. It does not punish ambition, but it asks the learner to choose. At C2, excellence is often the capacity to use less language more exactly.

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| 01 | <p>What is the main claim about highest-level proficiency?</p> <p>A. It removes the need for accuracy.</p> <p>B. It depends on rhetorical judgement, not just more grammar.</p> <p>C. It is mainly vocabulary quantity.</p> <p>_____</p> |
| 02 | <p>When can fluency become a problem?</p> <p>A. When it conceals vagueness.</p> <p>B. When it uses simple words.</p> <p>C. When it is too slow.</p> <p>_____</p>                                                                         |
| 03 | <p>Why is correctness insufficient?</p> <p>A. Correctness is irrelevant.</p> <p>B. Grammar cannot be assessed.</p> <p>C. Different contexts require different rhetorical choices.</p> <p>_____</p>                                       |
| 04 | <p>What does proportionate language mean?</p> <p>A. Language without nuance.</p> <p>B. The longest possible answer.</p> <p>C. Language suited to situation and purpose.</p> <p>_____</p>                                                 |
| 05 | <p>What can a simplistic prompt conceal?</p> <p>A. Excellent handwriting.</p> <p>B. Weak interpretation.</p> <p>C. Fast reading only.</p> <p>_____</p>                                                                                   |

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| 06 | <p>What risk does an excessively academic prompt create?</p> <p>A. It may reward genre familiarity rather than control.</p> <p>B. It makes grammar impossible.</p> <p>C. It removes vocabulary.</p> <p>_____</p>     |
| 07 | <p>What should C2 grammar items test?</p> <p>A. Only spelling.</p> <p>B. Judgement as well as form.</p> <p>C. Only speed.</p> <p>_____</p>                                                                           |
| 08 | <p>What does editorial conversation imply?</p> <p>A. Precise developmental feedback.</p> <p>B. A casual chat without standards.</p> <p>C. A final punishment.</p> <p>_____</p>                                       |
| 09 | <p>What does complexity becomes ornament mean?</p> <p>A. Ornament improves clarity.</p> <p>B. Complex language used decoratively rather than purposefully.</p> <p>C. All complex language is wrong.</p> <p>_____</p> |
| 10 | <p>What is excellence at C2 often described as?</p> <p>A. Avoiding all risk.</p> <p>B. Speaking as fast as possible.</p> <p>C. Using less language more exactly.</p> <p>_____</p>                                    |

## Listening

### Seminar exchange on advanced assessment

Audio track: C2-listening.mp3 on the website. If the recording is not uploaded yet, use the backup browser voice. The transcript is not printed in the student PDF.

01 What does advanced assessment over-reward?

- A. Short answers only.
  - B. Silence.
  - C. Visible complexity.
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02 What can complexity imitate?

- A. Attendance.
  - B. Thought.
  - C. Pronunciation.
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03 What is the subtle difference about position?

- A. Qualifying a position without becoming vague.
  - B. Changing the topic.
  - C. Avoiding any position.
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04 What should the writing prompt require?

- A. A list of definitions.
  - B. Judgement rather than summary.
  - C. Only copying.
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05 Which grammar areas are named?

- A. Concession, inversion, reduced clauses and register.
  - B. Alphabet and numbers.
  - C. Only present simple.
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| 06 | <p>Why is diagnosis partly editorial?</p> <p>A. It ignores grammar.</p> <p>B. It is only about punctuation.</p> <p>C. It checks whether language does the right work.</p> <hr/> |
| 07 | <p>What is meant by flattening meaning?</p> <p>A. Losing nuance while simplifying.</p> <p>B. Improving precision.</p> <p>C. Adding evidence.</p> <hr/>                          |
| 08 | <p>What is the speaker's attitude?</p> <p>A. Opposed to testing.</p> <p>B. Demanding but principled.</p> <p>C. Dismissive of advanced learners.</p> <hr/>                       |

## Writing

IELTS Academic/TOEFL advanced hybrid. Write 350-450 words: At the highest levels, language assessment should focus less on visible complexity and more on judgement, register and rhetorical control. Discuss this claim and qualify your position.

Teacher rubric: task response 0-5; organisation 0-5; grammar control 0-5; vocabulary range 0-5.

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## Speaking

Record 4 minutes as if responding in an academic interview. Compare two views of advanced assessment: one based on measurable accuracy, the other on rhetorical judgement. Include concession, counterexample, and a final refined position.

Record your answer on the website or prepare an audio file for the teacher.

### Preparation notes

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## Grammatical Range and Accuracy

01 Visible complexity may be impressive, \_\_\_\_ it is not necessarily precise.

A. whereby

B. despite

C. yet

\_\_\_\_\_

02 Were the prompt simplified too far, it \_\_\_\_ weak interpretation.

A. concealed

B. would conceal

C. will conceal

\_\_\_\_\_

03 The learner sounded fluent, if \_\_\_\_ evasive.

A. some

B. something

C. somewhat

\_\_\_\_\_

04 No sooner \_\_\_\_ a position than he qualified it.

A. he had stated

B. he stated

C. had he stated

\_\_\_\_\_

05 The issue is not so much accuracy \_\_\_\_ rhetorical control.

A. as

B. than

C. but

\_\_\_\_\_



|    |                                                                                                                                                   |
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| 06 | <p>Complexity should be treated as useful ____ purposeful.</p> <p>A. despite it is</p> <p>B. whereby it</p> <p>C. provided it is</p> <p>_____</p> |
| 07 | <p>The feedback, ____ severe, was productive.</p> <p>A. though</p> <p>B. despite</p> <p>C. whereas</p> <p>_____</p>                               |
| 08 | <p>A sentence may be correct without ____ appropriate.</p> <p>A. to be</p> <p>B. being</p> <p>C. be</p> <p>_____</p>                              |
| 09 | <p>It is crucial that register ____ assessed explicitly.</p> <p>A. is</p> <p>B. will be</p> <p>C. be</p> <p>_____</p>                             |
| 10 | <p>The task requires judgement, ____ mere summary.</p> <p>A. whereas</p> <p>B. rather than</p> <p>C. instead to</p> <p>_____</p>                  |

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| 11 | <p>Had the learner used fewer qualifiers, the argument ____ stronger.</p> <p>A. might sound</p> <p>B. might have sounded</p> <p>C. will sound</p> <p>_____</p> |
| 12 | <p>The phrase was precise, ____ slightly pedantic.</p> <p>A. albeit</p> <p>B. whereby</p> <p>C. despite</p> <p>_____</p>                                       |
| 13 | <p>Not only ____ the claim, but she refined it.</p> <p>A. did she defend</p> <p>B. she defended</p> <p>C. she did defend</p> <p>_____</p>                      |
| 14 | <p>The prompt was designed ____ evasive answers.</p> <p>A. to expose</p> <p>B. exposing</p> <p>C. expose</p> <p>_____</p>                                      |
| 15 | <p>The response lacked the restraint ____ C2 writing often requires.</p> <p>A. who</p> <p>B. where</p> <p>C. that</p> <p>_____</p>                             |

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| 16 | <p>The more advanced the learner, ____ subtle the feedback must be.</p> <p>A. more</p> <p>B. the more</p> <p>C. most</p> <p>_____</p> |
| 17 | <p>The argument was not wrong; ____, it was underdeveloped.</p> <p>A. despite</p> <p>B. whereby</p> <p>C. rather</p> <p>_____</p>     |
| 18 | <p>A diagnostic should account ____ register and implication.</p> <p>A. for</p> <p>B. of</p> <p>C. about</p> <p>_____</p>             |
| 19 | <p>The sentence was revised without ____ its nuance.</p> <p>A. to lose</p> <p>B. losing</p> <p>C. lose</p> <p>_____</p>               |
| 20 | <p>The speaker avoided commitment, ____ weakening the answer.</p> <p>A. despite</p> <p>B. whereas</p> <p>C. thereby</p> <p>_____</p>  |

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| 21 | <p>Useful ____ the framework is, it has limits.</p> <p>A. whereas</p> <p>B. despite</p> <p>C. though</p> <p>_____</p>                                      |
| 22 | <p>The learner's control appears ____ under timed conditions.</p> <p>A. to improving</p> <p>B. to have improved</p> <p>C. having improved</p> <p>_____</p> |
| 23 | <p>The distinction is subtle, ____ pedagogically significant.</p> <p>A. yet</p> <p>B. whereas</p> <p>C. despite</p> <p>_____</p>                           |
| 24 | <p>The answer was proportionate ____ the task.</p> <p>A. with</p> <p>B. to</p> <p>C. for</p> <p>_____</p>                                                  |
| 25 | <p>If feedback becomes too general, it ____ diagnostic value.</p> <p>A. loses</p> <p>B. would have lost</p> <p>C. had lost</p> <p>_____</p>                |

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The evaluator asked whether the register \_\_\_\_ the purpose.

A. has served

B. served

C. is serve

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